

Alejandro Gómez Salgado

Staff Engineer | Senior Software Engineer | Backend & Distributed Systems | Technical Leadership & Architecture

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Professional Summary

Senior Software Engineer with 20+ years of experience designing, building, and evolving enterprise-scale software platforms across fintech, financial services, retail pricing, payments, digital identity, and AI-driven systems.

Strong background in backend architecture, distributed systems, microservices, event-driven platforms, and large-scale modernization initiatives using Java, Spring Boot, Kafka, SQL, cloud-native infrastructure, and containerized environments.

Experienced leading complex technical initiatives through architecture definition, engineering execution, cross-functional collaboration, mentoring, and technical influence across multiple teams. Proven ability to drive scalable, maintainable, secure, and business-aligned solutions while supporting long-term engineering strategy and delivery excellence.

Hands-on technical leader with experience partnering across Engineering, Product, QA, Architecture, Platform, and Business stakeholders in fast-paced global organizations.

Core Competencies

- Staff-Level Technical Leadership
- Software Architecture & System Design
- Backend & Distributed Systems
- Microservices & REST API Design

- Event-Driven Architecture
- Platform Modernization
- Technical Mentorship & Engineering Coaching
- Code Review & Engineering Quality
- CI/CD & Deployment Workflows
- Secure Development Practices
- BDD / Gherkin Requirements Definition
- Reliability & Observability
- Performance Optimization
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Agile Delivery & Story Refinement

Technical Skills

Languages: Java (11/17), Python, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, Pro*C

Frameworks: Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Spring Data JPA, Spring Security, Hibernate, Apache Spark

Backend & Distributed Systems: Microservices Architecture, RESTful APIs, Kafka, Event-Driven Architecture, Workflow Orchestration, ETL & Batch Processing, Distributed Processing, Asynchronous Messaging

Databases: PostgreSQL, Oracle Database, IBM DB2, Azure Cosmos DB, SQL Optimization, Query Performance Tuning

Cloud & DevOps: AWS, Azure, Kubernetes, Docker, Rancher, Helm, GitHub Actions, Azure Pipelines, Harness, Terraform (collaborative exposure)

Testing: JUnit, Mockito, WireMock, Integration Testing, API Testing, BDD with Gherkin/Cucumber, Acceptance Criteria Definition, Applied TDD Principles

Monitoring & Observability: Dynatrace, Runtime Diagnostics, Application Monitoring, Performance Analysis, Incident Troubleshooting, Reliability Engineering

Security: OWASP Secure Development Practices, JWT, OAuth 2.0, Auth0, Spring Security, Static Code Analysis (SonarQube), Vulnerability Detection

Professional Experience

Senior Backend Software Engineer

Tech Mahindra — Kroger

Remote | July 2024 – May 2026

Built and maintained enterprise backend platforms supporting pricing optimization and payment workflows across large-scale retail operations. Focused on scalable, high-performance backend systems with emphasis on maintainability, reliability, operational continuity, and modernization.

Key Contributions

- Developed Spring Boot microservices and REST APIs supporting pricing optimization, validation, and payment workflows across multiple business divisions
- Built integrations across pricing engines, ETL pipelines, Kafka-based services, and downstream platform consumers
- Contributed to the Unified Pricing Engine proof of concept using Drools to support configurable enterprise pricing rules
- Supported migration from Enterprise Kafka to Kafka as a Service (KaaS)
- Led dependency analysis and rollout planning for decommissioning legacy National pricing services
- Improved backend reliability through SQL optimization, runtime diagnostics, and performance troubleshooting
- Participated in code reviews, engineering quality initiatives, CI/CD validation, and technical troubleshooting
- Worked with Gherkin-based integration test scenarios within CI/CD pipelines to validate business flows and investigate regressions
- Collaborated with Kubernetes deployment workflows including pod validation, configuration review, runtime logs, and decommission activities
- Partnered closely with QA, ETL, Product, and Platform teams to deliver scalable business-critical backend services

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, Kafka, Drools, PostgreSQL, IBM DB2, Azure Cosmos DB, Kubernetes, Helm, Rancher, GitHub Actions, Dynatrace

Technical Lead / Architect

Baufest — Lynk (Bank of Jamaica) / Innovation Lab

Remote | March 2022 – April 2024

Led backend engineering and architecture efforts across fintech and innovation initiatives including digital wallet operations, identity verification, financial integrations, and enterprise AI experimentation.

Key Contributions

- Led backend design and implementation of Java Spring Boot microservices supporting digital wallet operations and core financial workflows
- Designed secure APIs for authentication, remittances, money movement, and onboarding workflows
- Integrated Auth0 and OnFido for identity verification and secure customer access
- Designed and implemented Kafka-based event-driven workflows including producers, consumers, schema evolution, topic design, event validation, and asynchronous processing
- Supported modernization efforts migrating Node.js microservices into Java Spring Boot services through codebase analysis and functional parity implementation
- Evaluated React-based micro frontend architecture through proof-of-concept initiatives focused on modular frontend design and integration strategy
- Contributed to architecture definition for enterprise AI platform initiatives using Azure AI and OpenAI APIs
- Created Gherkin-based functional scenarios, story refinement, and acceptance criteria for engineering and QA alignment
- Led code reviews, technical design discussions, and engineering quality validation
- Worked with Azure Pipelines, Sonar quality gates, CI/CD automation, and deployment validation workflows
- Participated in release go/no-go decisions, production rollout execution, deployment readiness validation, and stakeholder communication during launch campaigns
- Worked with Kubernetes environments validating pod versions, Helm configurations, secrets management, scalability settings, runtime logs, and release verification
- Technical Lead for a squad of 3 engineers, 2 QA engineers, and Product Owner; additionally mentored 4 engineers through career development, performance feedback, and team-building initiatives, supporting professional growth and integration into Baufest engineering culture

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, Kafka, PostgreSQL, Auth0, OnFido, TypeScript, React, Node.js (migration analysis), Azure AI, OpenAI APIs, Kubernetes, Helm, Azure Pipelines, SonarQube

Software Consultant / Product Owner / Service Delivery Manager

Equifax / Inffinix Software

Mexico City / Dublin | July 2004 – March 2022

Led evolution and modernization of enterprise software platforms supporting global Collections & Recoveries operations across large-scale financial systems.

Key Contributions

- Designed and developed enterprise backend systems supporting complex global financial workflows
- Led modernization initiatives migrating legacy Pro*C batch processing into Java and Apache Spark distributed workloads
- Defined technical and functional requirements through business-driven scenarios and Gherkin-based workflows
- Led delivery across 2 Agile squads composed of engineers, QA, and technical leadership roles, coordinating execution, technical alignment, and cross-team collaboration
- Led code review processes and technical validation, documenting engineering standards, enforcing quality guidelines, and approving releases
- Supported release readiness and production deployment coordination for shared enterprise platforms
- Produced technical and operational documentation to guide modernization initiatives across international teams
- Managed knowledge transfer between Mexico and Dublin engineering organizations
- Mentored engineers while supporting Agile delivery execution, onboarding, and engineering collaboration
- Collaborated with AWS cloud-based deployments and Terraform-supported infrastructure workflows

Technologies: Java, Apache Spark, SQL, Pro*C, Oracle Database, PostgreSQL, Angular, TypeScript, AWS, Terraform

Leadership & Engineering Strengths

- Staff-level technical leadership through architecture, technical guidance, and engineering influence
- Strong mentoring experience across senior and junior engineers
- Cross-functional collaboration with Engineering, Product, QA, Architecture, Platform, and Business teams
- Strong ownership of engineering quality through code reviews, technical standards, and best practices
- Deep expertise in scalable backend systems and distributed architecture
- Experience driving modernization while preserving business continuity in mission-critical platforms
- Strong adaptability across enterprise, fintech, and innovation-driven environments

Education

Bachelor's Degree in Applied Mathematics — Numerical Methods & Artificial Intelligence

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México (ITAM)

Diploma in Information Technologies Project Management

Tecnológico de Monterrey